Last updated: October 31, 2026

ZIRUI SONG

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology **September 2023 - May 2028 (Expected)**

Ph.D. in Accounting

The University of Chicago **August 2017 - May 2021**

B.S. in Mathematics, Economics with Honors, and Statistics; *Summa Cum Laude*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Banking, Debt Contracting, Corporate Finance

WORKING PAPERS

Tax Policy and Syndicated Loan Contracting [SSRN]
With Edward L. Maydew (UNC), Matthew A. Phillips (Northwestern)

R&R at *Journal of Accounting Research*.
Presentations at the 3rd Annual NYU Big Apple Accounting Conference, IESE Tax Conference 2025, the 15th EIASM Conference on the Current Research in Taxation, the Emerging Scholars in Accounting Conference at Boston University, the MIT PhD student brown bag, University of Toronto, University of Utah, and University of Florida.

When Expertise Matters: Loan Officer Industry Specialization, Loan Pricing, and Contract Design [SSRN]
Solo-authored

R&R at *Review of Accounting Studies*.
Second Year Paper. Presentations at MIT.

Organization of Human Capital in Corporate Lending [SSRN]
With Young Soo Jang (Penn State), Vrinda Mittal (UNC)

Presentations at the MIT Econometrics Clinic 2026, ISB Summer Conference 2026, Philadelphia Fed 2026, Wharton-Chicago-Harvard Insolvency and Restructuring Conference 2026, Stability Implications of Nonbank Provision of Financial Services Conference 2026, RCF-ECGI 2026, FIFI 2026, Private Equity Research Consortium Symposium 2026, University of Amsterdam (scheduled), Tilburg (scheduled), Erasmus (scheduled), Georgetown (scheduled), CEPR Paris Symposium 2026 (scheduled), and Labor Markets and Financial Markets Workshop, IAB 2026 (scheduled).

Firms' Leverage Targets [SSRN]
With Jiacheng Liu (Renmin)

Presentations at MIT Finance Lunch.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Information Covenants in Nonbanking Direct Lending
With Matthew A. Phillips (Northwestern), Joseph P. Weber (MIT)

First Year Paper. Presentations at MIT (2x).

OTHER WRITING

Why Stock Buybacks Increase Financial Stability in Banking
With S.P. Kothari (MIT), Hamid Mehran (Independent)

Pro Market, Chicago Booth

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant – Prof. Kerry Siani 2024
Research Professional – Prof. Christian Leuz and Joao Granja 2021-2023

ACADEMIC CONFERENCE

Boston Accounting Students Symposium (*Organizer*)	2026
Fixed Income and Financial Institutions Conference (*Presenter*)	2026
Private Equity Research Consortium Symposium	2026
2nd Symposium on Private Firms: Reporting, Financing, and the Aggregate Economy	2025
3rd Annual NYU Big Apple Accounting Conference	2025
IESE Tax Conference (*Presenter*)	2025
15th EIASM Conference on the Current Research in Taxation (*Presenter & Discussant*)	2025
AAA Annual Meeting (*Discussant*)	2025
Kellogg Debt Markets Conference	2025
7th Annual Workshop on Financial Institutions Research	2025
Boston Accounting Students Symposium	2025
Boston Accounting Students Symposium	2024
Boston Accounting Students Symposium	2023
Journal of Accounting and Economics Conference	2023

REFEREE EXPERIENCE

Journal of Accounting and Economics, AAA Annual Meeting, FARS Midyear Meeting

AWARDS AND HONORS

MIT Sloan PhD Fellowship	2023-2028
Dean's List (University of Chicago)	2017-2021

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant for Professors Weber, Hanlon, Vetter, and Xie 2026

15.539 Doctoral Seminar in Accounting, PhD

Teaching Assistant for Professor Nemit Shroff 2026

15.720 Corporate Financial Accounting, EMBA

Teaching Assistant for Professor S.P. Kothari 2025

15.511 Sloan Fellows MBA (Financial Accounting)

Rating: Mean = 6.4/7, Median = 7/7

Teaching Assistant for Professor S.P. Kothari 2024

15.511 Sloan Fellows MBA (Financial Accounting)

Rating: Mean = 6.4/7, Median = 7/7

SKILLS

Python, Stata, R, Julia, MATLAB, Latex, Git, Bash, SLURM, SQL

ACTIVITIES

Inaugural MIT Sloan Student Activities Committee	2024, 2025, 2026
MIT Sloan Basketball Team	2024